Government Policies: Defence and Foreign Affairs

Official Source Scope (checked 14 October 2026)

This document summarises public-facing official services discovered through the National Portal's Defence and Foreign Affairs category [GOV-DEFENCE-PORTAL]. Source identifiers resolve to official URLs in docs/corpus_sources.json. It covers citizen services, welfare, training and industry facilitation. It does not report current operations, recruitment vacancies, defence budgets or changing country-specific travel requirements. Application routes, jurisdiction, documents and eligibility must be checked for the particular service. Training-case records elsewhere in this corpus are not official defence or consular forms.

Defence and Foreign-Affairs Responsibilities [GOV-DEFENCE-PORTAL]

The category identifies the Ministry of Defence and Ministry of External Affairs as associated authorities. It describes defence modernisation, domestic production, research and development, and strategic planning, alongside diplomacy and foreign-affairs services. Defence production support, veteran pension administration, cadet enrolment and consular services have different beneficiaries and decision-making authorities. In corpus reporting exercises, state which service, authority, reporting period and delivery stage a claim concerns; these measurement distinctions are editorial guidance.

Defence Industry Assistance [GOV-DEFENCE-INVESTMENT]

The Department of Defence Production's current industry portal states that a Defence Investment Cell has taken over the former Defence Investor Cell. It describes information and query support relating to investment opportunities, procedures and regulatory requirements in defence manufacturing. The Department's stated objectives include stronger production infrastructure and self-reliance in design, development and production. A query answered or an investor assisted is not itself an industrial licence, procurement contract, funding award or operational production facility. In corpus reporting exercises, distinguish an enquiry, a regulatory application, approval, investment actually made and production commissioned. These are editorial measurement distinctions; sector-specific permissions remain subject to the relevant authorities.

SPARSH: Defence Pension Services [GOV-SPARSH] [GOV-SPARSH-FAQ]

SPARSH stands for System for Pension Administration Raksha. CGDA describes a web-based defence-pension system for processing claims and crediting pension to pensioners' bank accounts. Its service-centre information includes pensioner data verification, profile changes, access to Pension Payment Orders and pension slips, annual life certification, service requests and grievances. The official FAQ describes payment-related grievances through the pensioner's account, support channels or a service centre. A pension claim initiated, pension sanctioned, identification completed and payment actually credited are distinct stages in corpus reporting exercises. A profile update or completed grievance is not, on its own, proof that an incorrect pension amount was corrected; that distinction is editorial guidance. Eligibility and entitlement amounts depend on the applicable pension rules and individual record.

NCC Enrolment and Training [GOV-NCC-ENROLMENT]

The National Government Services Portal describes National Cadet Corps enrolment as a voluntary training programme for school and college students, with online enrolment support. Cadet registration and participation should be distinguished from training completed, a certificate earned or subsequent selection for an Armed Forces career. This distinction is editorial guidance. The service listing does not establish a universal recruitment entitlement, an automatically available place or a uniform current application deadline; check the applicable institution and NCC enrolment instructions.

Passport Seva Services [GOV-PASSPORT]

The Ministry of External Affairs' Passport Seva service lists fresh and re-issue ordinary passports, Tatkaal services, diplomatic or official passports, Police Clearance Certificates and application tracking. Appointment availability, submission and application status are separate service stages. In corpus reporting exercises, keep the service type, applicant reference, appointment, verification where applicable, issuance and receipt separate. A booked appointment is not a passport issued, and passport issuance does not establish that a destination has granted a visa or permission to enter. These are editorial reporting distinctions. Fees, required documents, verification arrangements and overseas application routes must be checked with the relevant official service or Indian Mission or Post.

e-Sanad: Verification, Attestation and Apostille [GOV-ESANAD]

MEA's e-Sanad platform supports verification, attestation and apostille of personal, educational and commercial documents issued in India. Its description requires the relevant document to be available through an integrated digital repository for the online route. Verification by the document-issuing authority precedes MEA attestation or apostille. The official FAQ explains that an apostille authenticates the relevant signature or seal and capacity of the signatory; it does not certify the content of the underlying document. A document uploaded, issuer verification completed and apostille issued are different stages. In corpus reporting exercises, do not equate apostille with a foreign institution accepting an educational qualification, a job offer or a visa; those distinctions are editorial guidance. Check the route for the issuing authority and the requirements of the receiving country or institution.

MADAD: Consular Grievances and Students Abroad [GOV-MADAD]

MEA's MADAD portal supports logging and tracking grievances relating to consular services delivered by Indian Missions or Posts abroad. It also provides a separate registration module for Indian students studying or planning to study abroad, including course and contact details. A student profile is not a consular grievance, a scholarship award or confirmation that assistance was delivered. MEA's guidance explains that Missions must act within the host country's laws and cannot intervene in another country's legal proceedings beyond what those laws permit [GOV-CONSULAR-GUIDE]. Consular assistance is not a guarantee of a foreign visa, court outcome or immediate repatriation. In corpus reporting exercises, distinguish a request registered, a Mission assigned, advice or assistance provided and the outcome verified; these are editorial measurement distinctions.

Measurement and Record Handling

Do not combine passports issued, pension payments, cadet registrations, documents apostilled, investor queries and consular grievances into one beneficiary total. They have different units and may count repeat contacts with the same person. Retain the service reference, authority, stage, date, relevant evidence and any correction trail. Personal passport, pension, family and consular records should be restricted to the necessary service purpose rather than exposed in public case-level dashboards. These are corpus reporting conventions, not a new government form or a substitute for the applicable service rules.